



Coat with applied tasselled gold braid, only done up at waist

Colourful, patterned, long waistcoat

1730

Red-heeled shoes, a style associated with aristocracy

Silk hose (stockings) worn over breeches

Revealing skirts The skirts of men's coats were often stiffened with buckram so that they stood away from the body showing the richly decorated waistcoat beneath. Waistcoat panels were woven or embroidered to shape before being stitched together.



Single roll at side of bag wig

Gold braid or gold embroidered decoration

Bright pink silk coat

1747

Black breeches

Bag wig By the 1740s throughout both mainland Europe and the European colonies most men wore a wig. The prevalent style was the bag wig, with a series of rolls at the side, and the tail caught up into a small bag at the back.



Bag wig with two side curls

Frock with fold-over collar

Close-fitting sleeves

Tricorn hat

1765

Shoes with oval buckles

Side vents, to take a sword, required wear at court

Tricorn hat A hat was an essential part of a man's ensemble, and the tricorn was the height of fashion in the mid-18th century. As wigs became taller in the 1760s, the tricorn was carried increasingly under the arm.



Natural hair

Tight-fitting sleeves

Buff waistcoat and breeches

1769

Turn-down riding boots

Sporting clothes Thomas Graham, Baron Lynedoch, who later fought in the Napoleonic wars, was a Scottish country gentleman and a daring rider in his youth. Country dress worn for such sporting activities was known as a particularly British style.

WAISTCOATS



Embroidery in silk or linen

Long linen waistcoat with rich detailing



Embroidered floral trails at edge

Long waistcoat with floral sprig motif



Silver metal thread

Linen waistcoat with metal braid

In the 1720s and 30s men wore long waistcoats, and there was a vogue for hand-embroidered whitework styles in white cotton or linen threads on a white linen ground. The mid-18th century saw the start of more colour, with delicate naturalistic embroidery in coloured silk threads, sometimes with metal thread, around the waistcoat edges and the pocket flaps. There were embroidery workshops throughout Europe, with the finest in France and England. Portraits also show men wearing waistcoats decorated with broad bands of applied braid, giving a military appearance.